

BLINK
by
The Cabin Boyz

Contact the Cabin Boyz:
Matt Cohen - cameltoadmail@gmail.com
Shawn DePasquale - shawnwrites@gmail.com

A cozy Valley backyard. String lights dangle from a wooden pagoda, illuminating a massive table covered in maps, dice, snacks, and half-empty beers and soda cans.

ROLAND, 30s, Dungeon Master, presides at the head of the table like a king on his throne, even though this is Eddie's house. He adjusts his DM screen with grand ceremony.

ROLAND
...and over the boggy horizon,
through the smoke of ages... IT
arrives.

Around the table, the players lean in:

JAKE, 30s, dad-bodied, lovable, golden retriever energy.

EDDIE, 30s, wiry, restless, nursing a beer.

SUSANNAH, 30s, Eddie's girlfriend, sharp-eyed, focused on her sheet.

DONNIE, 30s, quiet, a bit withdrawn, clearly the newest to the group.

ROLAND (CONT'D)
...THE LEVIATHAN!

Jake practically jumps out of his seat. Eddie grins, feeding off Jake's excitement.

JAKE
No way? The final boss!? Yeehaw!

EDDIE
About time, Roland. Lets merc this
undead fool!

Susannah studies the battle map on the table.

SUSANNAH
If it's under twenty-two AC, Lady
Stabington can ice him in one
turn. Just putting that out there.

ROLAND
(smugly)
This is a carefully crafted climax,
Susannah.

Eddie sighs, sips his beer.

EDDIE
That's code for most of us are
gonna die.

SUSANNAH
You might, Lady Stabington will
live forever.

Eddie laughs. Donnie leans toward Jake.

DONNIE
(quiet, to Jake)
She always this intense?

Before Jake can answer, the sliding glass door opens. **BILLY**,
30s, Eddie's cousin, pokes his head out.

BILLY
Hey, Cuz. Donde Esta your Nutella?

EDDIE
(annoyed)
Billy, you promised to stay inside.

BILLY
UNLESS it was an emergency.

EDDIE
You have a Nutella emergency?

BILLY
I'm making Crepes! Who wants one?

JAKE
Won't say no!

ROLAND
I could eat.

DONNIE
(to Jake)
Oh, are we like staying for dinner?
I didn't realize this was an all
night thing.

BILLY
So... the Nutella...?

EDDIE
In the kitchen if I have any.

BILLY
Ohhhhhhhh. I was WAY off.

Billy pulls his head back inside and closes the door.

Roland claps his hands, ready to get started.

ROLAND
Roll for initiative, please.

SUSANNAH
(rolls first)
Fuck. Snake eyes.

Eddie, Jake, and Donnie call out their initiative rolls; 12, 18, 10, respectively.

ROLAND
Okay, Jake's up first.

Jake beams, grabs his dice.

JAKE
Yes! Sir Jake the Snakelord summons every snake I've befriended across the realms. Snake Strike, baby.

ROLAND
You'll need a perfect roll to pull it off, Snakelord.

JAKE
I'll just roll perfectly then.

The group "ooooos" at the challenge.

Jake stands, blows on the dice, and rolls. It spins, wobbles... lands on a 20.

JAKE (CONT'D)
BIG. HEALTHY. NATTY TWENTY!

The table erupts into cheers.

DONNIE
(Clueless)
Is that good? Is it over?

Roland doesn't celebrate. He holds up a hand.

ROLAND
Sorry... but the Leviathan's serpent heritage and insane charisma already has the snake population under his command..

The group deflates. Jake's jaw drops.

JAKE
What the HECK? I rolled a crit!

EDDIE
Yeah, c'mon Roland that's kind of
sadistic. Even for you.

Roland shrugs, smug.

ROLAND
It's not sadistic. It's *lore*.

The group groans loudly. Eddie mutters under his breath.

POP.

SUSANNAH
Soooo, can Lady Stabbington the
third roll to fuck up the Leviathan
NOW?

The group turns their attention back to the DM, but--

Roland's chair is empty.

JAKE
...Rolo?

Donnie peers under the table.

DONNIE
Is this... like, part of the game?

The door slides open. Billy returns with a plate of crepes.

BILLY
Okay, here's the--

He freezes. Follows the group's eyes to Roland's empty chair.

BILLY (CONT'D)
Where's your buddy?

EDDIE
Did you not see him inside?

SUSANNAH
Okay, Roland, you can dramatically
reveal yourself now.

They wait. No answer.

DONNIE
(to Jake)
Is he mad you guys questioned his
lore?

JAKE
(calling out)
C'mon, Roland. This is silly.

No response from Roland. They all exchange puzzled looks.

JAKE (CONT'D)
Guys... where is he?

2 **INT. EDDIE'S HOUSE - QUICK CUT MONTAGE** 2

The group searches for Roland. Bedroom. Bathroom. Front yard.
Garage. All empty.

3 **EXT. EDDIE'S BACKYARD - MOMENTS LATER** 3

Everyone regroups at the table.

SUSANNAH
Any luck?

No one says a word.

Susannah pulls out her phone. Makes a call.

Under the table, Roland's phone BUZZES on top of a pile of
his clothes that the group had overlooked.

Eddie lifts the clothes and phone, laying them on the table.

Susannah ends the call.

SUSANNAH (CONT'D)
He's hiding from us, AND he's
naked?

The color drains from Billy's face.

BILLY
Oh. Oh, my sweet Lord in heaven.
This is it... He was RAPTURED! The
end of days is here!

EDDIE
He's just fucking with us.

BILLY
No! I told you, Eddie! You're
playing the Devil's game! Spitting
in God's face. Right in God's
mouth!

JAKE
Ew.

Eddie rolls his eyes.

BILLY
It's not the ra--

Billy rips off his shirt, runs into the grass.

BILLY (CONT'D)
LORD, TAKE ME!

SUSANNAH
Someone's gonna call the cops.

BILLY
FILL ME WITH YOUR DIVINE LIGHT!

Eddie closes his eyes, face twisted in frustration.

EDDIE
Billy! It's not the rapture! Will
you stop!

BILLY
PLEASE ACCEPT ME INTO YOUR--

POP

Billy's pants and crocs collapse in the grass.

The group SCREAMS. Jake knocks over his beer.

JAKE
WHAT THE SHIT!

DONNIE
He was right? About the Jesus
thing?

Eddie stares at the pile of clothes, pale.

EDDIE
(quiet)
Guys... I think I messed up.

SUSANNAH
What're you talking about?

EDDIE
(shaken)
He wouldn't stop screaming. I
thought... I just wanted him
gone... like inside... but then--

SUSANNAH
Eddie, you sound fucking insane.

JAKE
Yeah, people don't just... think
someone away.

EDDIE
Well, it's obviously not the
Rapture. Right?

Everyone sheepishly nods.

EDDIE (CONT'D)
And Roland was being such a dick...
not letting Jake have that roll. I
think... I think I maybe thought
him away too?

Donnie eyes Eddie, cautious.

DONNIE
Then try it on purpose.

Everyone looks at him like he's lost his mind.

DONNIE (CONT'D)
(defensively)
Not on us! I mean on like... a bad
person or something.

JAKE
Eddie wouldn't disappear someone.
He's not like that.

EDDIE
Actually... he's not wrong. We all
saw what we saw, and if I AM doing
this, we need to know for sure,
right?

Donnie nods. Susannah doesn't look convinced.

SUSANNAH
Are you guys out of your minds?

JAKE
Eddie's right. We have to test
this. But... who is so bad they
deserve to be... blinked away?

The boys exchange a look. Then, they all nod.
Eddie closes his eyes and focuses really hard.
After a beat, he looks around. They wait. Nothing.

SUSANNAH
Edward Gilead King, who did you
just try and disappear?

All their phone buzz at once. They look down...

BREAKING NEWS - President Disappears Mid Press Conference.

Eddie drops his phone like it's burning him.

EDDIE
I just John Wilkes Booth'd a
President.

He staggers inside, shaken.

JAKE
Well good news--he got away with
it, right?

CUT TO:

4

INT. EDDIE'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Everyone's on the couch. TV light flickers on their faces.

VIRGINIA FERNOW (V.O.)
(from TV)
...and then he just vanished.
They're ushering us out of the
White House now, Rachel. We're--

Jake grabs turns the TV off.

JAKE
That's enough of that.

Eddie sinks deeper into the couch, trembling.

EDDIE
Did I just kill the president?

Jake stares, jaw slack. Donnie won't make eye contact with anyone. Susannah steadies herself.

JAKE
Let's not jump to conclusions.

EDDIE
What jump!? You heard it on the news!

Susannah puts a hand on Eddie's leg.

SUSANNAH
Eddie, look at me. You're okay.
Just stay calm, you don't want--

He recoils, guilt flaring.

EDDIE
Don't. I mean... I'm sorry. I
just... I need a minute. Okay?!

He bolts to the bathroom. Door SLAMS.

Jake and Susannah share a worried look. Donnie stands.

DONNIE
Yeah.... We should all go. Now.

JAKE
I'm not leaving my best friend.

DONNIE
I thought *I* was your best friend!

JAKE
You're a *good* friend. But I've
known Eddie since forever. He was
at my Bar Mitzvah, man. I'm not
bailing on him.

DONNIE
(to Susannah)
You?

SUSANNAH
He's my boyfriend. I'm not scared
of him. We'll get through this.

Donnie stares at them, horrified.

DONNIE
Cool. Enjoy your crepes. Nice
meeting you, lady.
(MORE)

DONNIE (CONT'D)
 Jake, I'll catch you on Fortnite.
 Peace and chicken grease.

He BOLTS for the front door without looking back and sprints outside!

After a beat, Eddie walks back into the living room, staring at his phone.

EDDIE
 The fuck is your friend running to?

Eddie turns the phone toward Jake, showing live Ring camera footage of Donnie BOOKING it out of Eddie's front gate..

JAKE
 I... he's just a little freaked out, man.

EDDIE
 He's running to his car! He's gonna tell someone. The cops. The FBI. Fucking Mossad!

SUSANNAH
 Eddie, you don't know that--

EDDIE
 Look how fast he's running. Jake, did you know he was that fast?

Jake shakes his head nervously as Eddie starts pacing.

EDDIE (CONT'D)
 They're gonna come for me. They'll lock me up! Experiment on me like E.T!

SUSANNAH
 Let's just be calm.

EDDIE
 (Looking crazy and not calm at all)
 I'm super calm.

Eddie closes his eyes, jaw clenched.

JAKE
 Eddie, wait--

Eddie's face hardens.

CUT TO:

5 **EXT. EDDIE'S STREET - CONTINUOUS**

5

Donnie is hauling ass down the block when--

POP.

His clothes collapse in the street.

6 **INT. EDDIE'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS**

Eddie stares at the closed door, pale, trembling.

Jake and Susannah wait. The silence hangs heavy.

Eddie slowly walks back to the couch. Sits down carefully.

Jake and Susannah exchange a look.

SUSANNAH

(Sad)

Eddie. You didn't...

EDDIE

What? What happened?

SUSANNAH

Where's Donnie?

EDDIE

(Beat)

I'm sure he's fine.

SUSANNAH

Where is he, Eddie? Did you kill him?

EDDIE

(offended)

No, because I'm not a killer, Susannah. But thanks.

SUSANNAH

Then where is he? Where are any of them?

JAKE

Okay. Okay. We don't know for sure they're dead. Maybe... you sent them somewhere else.

EDDIE

Right. Like a tropical island, or another dimension where it rains ice cream.

SUSANNAH

Have you tried to bring them back? From... wherever they are.

EDDIE

...Bring them back? Yeah... Worth a shot.

He closes his eyes, clenching his fists, muttering like a kid trying to blow out birthday candles.

Nothing happens.

SUSANNAH

(Staring at Eddie)

I can't believe you murdered them.

EDDIE

It was an accident, babe! Plus, it's not murder if it's self defense.

SUSANNAH

How is it self defense to blink people out of existence as they're running away?

EDDIE

I did it to protect US. You really think the government would be cool with me having this power?

SUSANNAH

Enough with that! Life is not a kids movie from the 70's. No one is coming to dissect you, Eddie.

JAKE

Speaking of dissect, lets get into those crepes, huh? I think we're all a bit hangry.

Eddie ignores Jake, staring intensely at Susannah.

SUSANNAH

You can't prove Donnie was going to turn you in to anyone.

EDDIE

You can't prove he WASN'T going to tell. He was freaking the fuck out.

SUSANNAH

So that means he deserves to die?

EDDIE

It's called self preservation.
Google it.

SUSANNAH

Google "Sociopath." Both of you.

JAKE

I have to google that?! What did I do?

She shakes her head.

SUSANNAH

This is fucking crazy.

JAKE

But, like, isn't life crazy
sometimes though?

SUSANNAH

(To Jake)

Okay, Wormtongue.

EDDIE

Don't call him Wormtongue!

(beat)

Hey, wait--I'm not Saruman! Fuck
you.

SUSANNAH

This is fucked, Eddie. I can't... I
can't be here right now.

She grabs her bag, stands up.

EDDIE

What're you talking about? Where is
there to be?

SUSANNAH

I need some space to think about
this.

EDDIE

(devastated)

Like... space-space?

(MORE)

EDDIE (CONT'D)
(beat)
You're breaking up with me?

SUSANNAH
I... no... I don't know! I just
can't look at you right now.

He stands, reaches for her. She steps back.

EDDIE
I see. I can't trust you either?

SUSANNAH
Trust me to do what? Hide your
murders for you? I don't want that
on my *soul*.

EDDIE
I didn't--Fuck. You're making me
sound like a monster.

SUSANNAH
Eddie, I love you. But you're
acting like a monster. I'm done.

She turns toward the door. Eddie's voice breaks.

EDDIE
We're still going to Kauai next
week, right? We've been excited for
months, and I don't want to let a
little thing like this--

Susannah turns back, incredulous.

SUSANNAH
A little thing? Are you fucking
serious? Do you not hear yourself?

JAKE
(trying to help)
I mean, Kauai's probably non-
refundable so...

SUSANNAH
Shut the fuck up, Jake.

She looks back at Eddie, shaking her head.

SUSANNAH (CONT'D)
If you can't see anything wrong
with this, you need help. Serious
help. Before you--

She stops herself. Continues to the door.

EDDIE
Before I what? Hurt YOU? I would
never. You know that.

SUSANNAH
I don't know anything right now.

Eddie follows her to the door.

EDDIE
Hold on. Susannah, wait--

SUSANNAH
Let me GO, Eddie.

EDDIE
I can't! You can't just walk out!
Not after--

SUSANNAH
Watch me.

She turns the doorknob.

Eddie's face twists; he's hurt, desperate, cornered.

EDDIE
Please.

She opens the door.

POP.

Susannah's clothes slump to the floor. Her purse clatters
down beside them.

Jake GASPS, scrambling back. Eddie stares at the empty
doorway, frozen.

EDDIE (CONT'D)
(Horrified)
Fuck me.

JAKE
(whispering)
Uh oh, uh oh, uh oh.

Eddie sinks down beside her clothes.

EDDIE
I didn't want her to... Oh god. She
just... *Fuck*...

Eddie looks up at Jake, desperate. Jake backs away slightly.

EDDIE (CONT'D)
Don't look at me like that, dude.
You're my best friend in the world.
PLEASE don't be scared of me.

Jake hesitates, then nods slowly.

JAKE
Yeah. No. I know... you're right...
It's just... that was your
girlfriend, dude.

EDDIE
Don't tell me you're scared of me
now too.

JAKE
I love you, brother, but I have a
wife and kids. I can't get
disappeared from my family.

EDDIE
I'm not gonna. I love your wife and
kids. I promise. I swear to God,
dude. We're family, Jake.

JAKE
Yeah.. yeah... okay. You're right.
We're good.

Eddie nods enthusiastically with desperate, manic energy.

EDDIE
We're best bros. Let's just chill
and get really high and pass out
and maybe we wake up tomorrow and
this whole thing's gone. Like it
never happened. Like a bad dream.

Jake forces a smile, voice too bright.

JAKE
Right. Like a shared bad dream.
That happens! Great call, best
friend!

Jake side-eyes the exit.

EDDIE
I don't know what I'd do without
you, man. Seriously.

TIME CUT TO:

7

INT. EDDIE'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - EVENING

The room is hazy with smoke. Eddie and Jake play Fortnite, howling with laughter. A joint passes back and forth.

EDDIE
We murdered those kids so bad.

JAKE
(Forcing a laugh)
We sure got them. Take that... dead
kids.
(beat)
Hey, I gotta drain the tank. Ready
up. I'll be right back.

EDDIE
Cool cool. And buddy... thank you.
I'm so glad everything is back to
normal.

Jake sets the controller down and heads to the bathroom.

A few moments pass.

Eddie is zoned out, eyes glassy, controller limp in his
hands, staring at the loading screen art.

Then -- WHAM!

The glass bong CRACKS against his skull. It doesn't break.
Eddie stumbles, clutching his head.

EDDIE (CONT'D)
(aghast)
OW! What the fuck, dude?! That
hurt!!!

Jake grips the bong like a bat, shaking, crying already.

JAKE
I'm sorry, man! You're my best
friend but I gotta do this. For my
family. For the world at large!

EDDIE

I told you I'm not gonna hurt you!
You know what you mean to me.

JAKE

Well, you just killed Susannah and
she gave you head all the time!

Eddie flinches, tears flooding.

EDDIE

(blubbering)

I didn't mean to! I mean... fuck, I
loved her! But I love you even
more, man! I would never hurt you.

JAKE

I know! I love you, but I'm fucking
terrified of you!

They're both crying now, voices breaking.

EDDIE

(through sobs)

Look... look at me, I didn't blink
you, okay? When you hit me with my
FAVORITE bong by the way. I didn't
do shit back to you. I can control
it!

JAKE

What if you can't?! Or you slip
up?! What if it's me next? My wife?
My small innocent children who
think of you as an uncle!

EDDIE

Bro, if you swing that thing again
I have to defend myself!

JAKE

Just let me kill you, man!

EDDIE

WHAT?! No!

He presses two fingers to his temple.

Jake's teary eyes go wide.

JAKE

What the fuck!! Don't do that
shit!!!

EDDIE
You leave me no choice, dude! Don't
try to kill me!

JAKE
I have to!

EDDIE
Then I have to defend myself!

JAKE
FUCK! I love you, man!

EDDIE
I love you too, bro!

They're nose to nose, screaming through tears, desperation
curdling into rage. Jake raises the bong higher. Eddie
presses harder into his temple.

SLAM TO BLACK:

THE END